INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, KANPUR
ACADEMIC SECTION

No. (P)/SPGC/IITK/2016-17/
May 05, 2017

MINUTES OF THE 08th MEETING OF THE SENATE POSTGRADUATE COMMITTEE (2016-17) HELD ON APRIL 25, 2017 (TUESDAY) AT 4:00 P.M. IN QIP CONFERENCE ROOM, ACADEMIC AFFAIRS BUILDING

Members Present: Drs. Rajesh Kitey, Nitin Kaistha, Samit Ray Chaudhuri, Santanu K Mishra, B Dasgupta, S Omar, S K Mehta, Sri Vanamala, Shikha Prasad, Ramesh Rampaniker, Sudeep Bhattacharjee, G Santhanam, Naren Naik, R Sankaramakrishnan, S Misra, Achla Raina, and Mr. Piyush Waehad Pandey.

Members Absent: Drs. Sarani Saha, Sri Sivakumar, D P Mishra, Mr. Sankalp Tiwari, Mr. Kumar Shashwat and Mr. Arjak Bhattacharjee.

Item 1: Confirmation of the minutes of the seventh meeting of the SPGC (2016-17) held on March 24, 2017.

The Minutes of the seventh meeting of the SPGC (2016-17) held on March 24, 2017 were confirmed.

Item 2: To ratify the following decisions taken /approvals given by the Chairperson, SPGC:

The SPGC ratified the following decisions taken /approval given by Chairperson, SPGC:

(a) Extension of the deadline for submission of theses beyond the due date to the following Ph.D. students:

S.No.	Roll No.	Name	Dept./IDP	Due date for submission of thesis	Extension granted upto
01	11205073	Anish Kumar	ME	19/03/2017	31/05/2017
02	Y9207072	Masthanvali Sayyad	CHM	16/04/2017	16/05/2017
03	10107087	Sushma Yadav	CHM	08/05/2017	08/08/2017
04	10107068	Bikramjit Sharma	CHM	27/04/2017	27/07/2017
05	Y9207065	Chandan Kumar Shahi	CHM	14/04/2017	23/06/2017

(b) Extension of the deadline for the State of the Art Seminar beyond the due date to the following Ph.D. students (first extension request):

S.No.	Roll No.	Name	Dept. /IDP	Due date of present SOTA	Extension granted upto
01	15109271	Pritam Banerjee	PHY	03/04/2017	03/07/2017
02	15109275	Suvankar Paul	PHY	05/04/2017	05/07/2017
03	15123266	Saroj Kumar Dash	ES	13/04/2017	07/05/2017
04	14102267	Mahesh Prasad	CHE	30/03/2017	31/05/2017
05	14115261	Manis Hazra	NET	28/03/2017	28/06/2017
06	14204265	Chetan Gupta	EE	20/04/2017	20/06/2017

(c) Leave on medical grounds granted with effect from January 01, 2017 to end of the semester 2016-17-II to Mr. Rudraksha Avinash Baburao (14104137) M.Tech. student, Dept. of Electrical Engineering.

(d) Leave for the Summer Term, 2016-17 granted to Ms. Suravi Bose (15116008) M.Tech. student, Photonics Science & Engineering Programme.

(e) Approval of a course (ES650) from the Dept. Earth Sciences with a change of course title from 'Special Topics in Earth Sciences' to 'Communication Skills in Earth Sciences' as per the suggestion of the SPGC (6th meeting held on 17/02/2017).

(f) Leave for the Summer Term, 2016-17 and semester 2017-18-I with permission to submit thesis during the leave period granted to Mr. Rahul Kumar Sinha (15116005) M.Tech. student, Photonics Science & Engineering Programme.

(g) Leave for the Summer Term 2016-17 with permission to submit the thesis during the leave period granted to Mr. Atul Kumar Singh (15112002) M.Tech. student, Materials Science Programme.

Item 3: Reporting Items:

The SPGC noted the following approvals given by the Chairperson, SPGC:

(a) Withdrawal from the PG programmes of the following PG students:

S.No.	Roll No.	Name	Dept./IDP	Program
01	15109273	Pushpajit Halder	PHY	Ph.D.
02	16102276	Shadman Hasan Khan	CHE	Ph.D.
03	16107294	Sumit Ghosh	CHM	Ph.D.

(b) Permission granted for appearing in the Ph.D. Comprehensive examination without participation in the seminar courses (MSE690/691) as a one time waiver to the following PhD students of the Dept. of Materials Science & Engineering:

S.No.	Roll No.	Name
01	15206267	Shishakant Gupta
02	16106270	Raghavendra R M
03	15206266	Sarvesha R
04	15206264	Karishma Jain
05	15106264	Gyanendra Pratap Singh

The members were of the view that since the matter is related to a department-internal requirement, it does not need the approval of the SPGC.

Item 5: Approval of courses:

The SPGC approved the following courses:

S. No.	Course No.	Title of course	Credits	Proposed by
01	CS786	Computational Cognitive Science	3-0-0-0-9	Dr. Nisheeth Srivastava
02	CS652	Computer Aided Verification	3-0-0-0-9	Dr. Indranil Saha
03	CS776	Deep Learning for Computer Vision	3-0-0-0-9	Dr. Gaurav Sharma
04	CS620	Modern Memory Systems	3-0-0-0-9	Dr. B Panda
05	ART711	Creative Painting-Methodology & Practices	2-0-3-0-9	Dr. Ritwij Bhowmik
06	AE666	Combustion Diagnostics	3-0-0-0-9	Drs. Vaibhav Arghode & D P Mishra

Item 6: To consider the request of Mr. Salil Goel (13103170), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Civil Engineering, for the award of 32 thesis credits for two semesters (2015-16-II & 2016-17-I) spent at University of Melbourne, Australia.

The SPGC approved the transferring of 32 thesis credits for two semesters (2015-16-II & 2016-17-I) spent by Mr. Salil Goel (13103170) at the University of Melbourne, Australia.

Item 7: To consider the request of Ms. Sanjukta Kundu (15109274), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Physics, for extension (beyond four semesters) of the deadline for appearing in the comprehensive examination till the end of next semester.

The SPGC granted extension till the end of the next semester for appearing in the comprehensive examination to Ms. Sanjukta Kundu (15109274). The decision is to be reported to the Senate.

Item 8: To consider the request of Mr. Somen Dey (15114265), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Industrial & Management Engineering, for extension (beyond four semesters) of the deadline for appearing in the comprehensive examination up to six months.

The SPGC granted extension till the end of Summer Term, 2016-17 for appearing in the comprehensive examination to Mr. Somen Dey (15114265). The decision is to be reported to the Senate.

Item 9: To consider the request of Mr. Amit Kumar Trivedi (15114261), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Industrial & Management Engineering, for extension (beyond four semesters) of the deadline for appearing in the comprehensive examination up to three months.

The SPGC granted extension up to three months for appearing in the comprehensive examination to Mr. Amit Kumar Trivedi (15114261). The decision is to be reported to the Senate.

Item 10: To consider the requests of the following Ph.D. students of the Dept. of Chemistry for leave for the summer term of 2017 for joining a teaching job with effect from April 26, 2017:

(a) Irshad Ahmad Bhat (11107074)
(b) Imtiyaz Ahmad Wani (13107070)
(c) Hilal Ahmad Pal (12207063)

The SPGC granted leave for the Summer Term, 2016-17 to the above mentioned PhD students. The members were of the opinion that SPGC should formalise the norms and procedure for such requests. The Chairperson was authorised to make a proposal which would be put up for consideration of the SPGC in its forthcoming meeting.

Item 11: To consider the request of Mr. Arka Ghosh (15118003), M.Tech. student, Dept. of Biological Sciences & Bioengineering, for change of academic registration from M.Tech. programme to Ph.D. programme.

The SPGC approved the change of academic registration from M.Tech. programme to PhD programme for Mr. Arka Ghosh (15118003). The conversion will be effective from the Summer Term, 2016-17. The decision is to be reported to the Senate.

Item 12: To consider the request of Mr. Randeep Ravesh (15205408), MS (By Research) student, Dept. of Mechanical Engineering, for change of academic registration from MS (By Research) programme to Ph.D. programme.

The SPGC approved the change of academic registration from MS (By Research) programme to PhD for Mr. Randeep Ravesh (15205408). The conversion will be effective from Summer Term, 2016-17. The decision is to be reported to the Senate.

Item 13: To consider the request of Mr. Saurabh Tewari (15119269), Ph.D. student, Design programme, for change of academic registration from Full-Time to Part-Time.

The SPGC approved the conversion of academic registration from Full-Time to Part-Time Ph.D. programme for Mr. Saurabh Tewari (15119269) under Section 4.8 of the PG Manual. The decision is to be reported to the Senate.

Item 14: To consider the request of Mr. Rohit Gupta (15111037), M.Tech. student, Dept. of Computer Science & Engineering, for medical leave from March 20, 2017 with the reduction of thesis credits to 9.

The SPGC approved the leave w.e.f. March 20, 2017 till end of the semester 2016-17-II for Mr. Rohit Gupta (15111037) on medical grounds with the reduction of thesis credits to 9.

Item 15: To consider the request of Convener, DPGC, Dept. of Materials Science & Engineering, for medical leave for Mr. M Venkata Krishna (16106018), M.Tech. student.

The SPGC recommended leave for the semester 2016-17-II on medical grounds for Mr. M Venkata Krishna (16106018). The recommendation is to be sent to the Chairman, Senate for approval.

Item 16: To consider the request of Ms. Bushara Fatima (12106064) PhD student, Dept. of Materials Science & Engineering, for leave from 21/02/2017 to 05/04/2017 on personal grounds.

The SPGC approved the leave from 21/02/2017 to 05/04/2017 retrospectively for Ms. Bushara Fatima (12106064) on personal grounds.

Item 17: To consider the request of Mr. Sayantan Sasmal (13112066), Ph.D. student, Materials Science Programme, for extension of academic leave upto January 31, 2018. The student is currently at National University of Singapore, under joint degree programme.

The SPGC granted extension of academic leave upto January 31, 2018 for Mr. Sayantan Sasmal (13112066).

Item 18: To consider the request of Mr. Rajesh Kumar (15407264), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Chemistry, for leave with effect from April 03, 2017 for three weeks for joining a teaching job.

The SPGC turned down the leave request of Mr. Rajesh Kumar (15407264) under Section 7.1 of the PG Manual.

Item 19: To consider the request of Mr. Sandeep Bari (16109282) Ph.D. student, Dept. of Physics, for adding 18 thesis credits in the current semester i.e., 2016-17-II.

The SPGC turned down the request of Mr. Sandeep Bari (16109282) to retrospectively add 18 thesis credits for the current semester.

Item 20: To consider the request of Ms. Varsha Shukla (14104283), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Electrical Engineering, for permission to defend her M.Tech. thesis before June 01, 2017. Ms. Shukla was allowed to exit from Ph.D. programme with an M.Tech. degree and the due date for M.Tech. thesis defense is June 06, 2017.

The SPGC permitted Ms. Varsha Shukla (14104283) to submit her M.Tech. thesis and to defend it before June 01, 2017.

Item 21: To consider the request of Mr. Saifi Izhar (16103278), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Civil Engineering, for addition of Dr. Arnico K Pandey, Senior Atmospheric Scientist & Programme Coordinator, Atmosphere Initiative (ICIMOD) as a co-supervisor from outside IIT Kanpur.

The SPGC recommended the addition of Dr. Arnico K Pandey, Senior Atmospheric Scientist & Programme Coordinator, Atmosphere Initiative (ICIMOD), as a co-supervisor from outside IIT Kanpur for Mr. Saifi Izhar (16103278). The recommendation is to be sent to the Chairman, Senate for approval.

Item 22: To consider the request of Mr. Kancharla Hari Krishna (16106266) Ph.D. student, Dept. of Materials Science & Engineering, for addition of Dr. G K Mandal, NML Jamshedpur as a co-supervisor from outside IIT Kanpur.

The SPGC recommended the addition of Dr. G K Mandal, NML Jamshedpur, as a co-supervisor from outside IIT Kanpur as a co-supervisor from outside IIT Kanpur for Mr. Kancharla Hari Krishna (16106266). The recommendation is to be sent to the Chairman, Senate for approval.

Item 23: To discuss the case of Mr. Manish Chauhan (15400261), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Humanities & Social Sciences, who has failed to clear the Comprehensive Examination in two attempts.

The SPGC recommended termination of the academic programme of Mr. Manish Chauhan (15400261).

Item 24: To consider the request of Mr. Saumik Bhattacharya (11104177), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Electrical Engineering, for the award of additional M.Tech. degree as per the recent decision of the Senate with regard to PhD students with a B.Tech./BS/M.Sc. background (491st/2016-17/2nd).

The SPGC was of the view that since the provision for additional M.Tech./MS degree will be implemented with effect from the academic semester 2017-18-I, Mr. Saumik Bhattacharya's request cannot not be considered at this stage. The student will be asked to make a fresh request once the provision is implemented.

Item 25: To consider the request of Mr. Ashok Ummireddi (12202063), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Chemical Engineering, for the award of additional M.Tech. degree as per the recent decision of the Senate with regard to Ph.D. students with a B.Tech./BS/M.Sc. background (491st/2016-17/2nd). Mr. Ummireddi had converted his M.Tech. programme to Ph.D. programme in 2012-13-II semester.

The SPGC clarified that the Ph.D. students who have converted their programme from M.Tech. to Ph.D. are eligible for the additional M.Tech. degree as per the provision approved in the 491st meeting of the Senate.

Item 26: To consider the request of Mr. Rajarshi Dutta (16204287), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Electrical Engineering, for leave on medical grounds for the semester 2016-17-II.

The SPGC recommended the leave for the semester 2016-17-II for Mr. Rajarshi Dutta (16204287) on personal grounds. The recommendation is to be sent to the Chairman, Senate for approval.

Item 27: To consider the request of Convener, DPGC of Dept. of Industrial & Management Engineering, for Summer Term grade submission after the stipulated deadline in the Academic Calendar.

The SPGC recommended that the grade submission deadline for the Summer Term may be relaxed up to July 30 in case of MBA and M.Tech. students of the Department of Industrial & Management Engineering, who proceed on Academic Leave during the Summer Term, provided that such relaxation does not violate the logistics of grade submission at the Institute.

Item 28: To consider the request of Mr. Divyansh Patel (13105165), PhD student, Dept. of Mechanical Engineering, for extension of leave during the Summer Term 2016-17. The student is currently on leave on personal grounds for the second consecutive semester.

The SPGC approved leave for the Summer Term, 2016-17 for Mr. Divyansh Patel (13105165) on personal grounds as a special case.

Item 29: To consider the request of Mr. Abhishek Singh to be allowed to register in the M.Tech. programme in the Dept. of Electrical Engineering and to resubmit his M.Tech. thesis. Mr. Abhishek Singh (13104006) was a student in the Dept. of Electrical Engineering, who received his M.Tech. degree in 2016. His M.Tech. degree was, however, revoked by the Board of Governors, IIT Kanpur on grounds of plagiarism. The case was considered in the seventh SPGC meeting held March 24, 2017, and the SPGC had asked for further inputs from the department on the case.

The SPGC considered the request of Mr. Abishek Singh to be allowed to resubmit his thesis. After detailed discussion, it was decided that since Mr. Singh's status is unclear, the matter be referred to the Senate for guidance on the following issue: Is the applicant required to be readmitted to the M.Tech. programme in Electrical Engineering in order to resubmit his thesis, or should he be allowed to register in the M.Tech. programme as a special case even though he is not a student of the Institute?

Item 30: To consider the feedback from the departments on guidelines for the award of M.Tech./MS degree to those students who take a direct admission into the Ph.D. programme after B.Tech./BS/M.Sc as per the decision of the Senate (491st/2016-17/2nd).

The discussion was deferred as many of the departments are yet to submit their feedback on the issue.

Item 31: To consider a proposal from the DOAA regarding modifications in the Ordinances and the PG Manual, IIT Kanpur.

The matter was deferred to the next meeting of the SPGC for want of time.

Item 32: Any other item with the permission of the Chair.

(a) The SPGC discussed the case of Mr. Pawan Kumar (15101037) M.Tech. student, Dept. of Aerospace Engineering, who had registered for two online courses (from outside IIT Kanpur) without prior information of the thesis supervisor. After discussion, it was concluded that registering for online courses outside the Institute does not require a prior permission of the SPGC though the thesis supervisor should have been consulted beforehand. However, SPGC categorically said that such an engagement could not be used as an excuse for underperformance in the programme.

(b) The SPGC considered the request of Convener, DPGC, Dept. of Industrial & Management Engineering, to extend the duration of the Oral Comprehensive Board beyond eight weeks in the case of Mr. Amit Kumar Trivedi (15114261) Ph.D. student, Dept. of Industrial & Management Engineering. After discussion, the committee extended the validity of Comprehensive Board for Mr. Amit Kumar Trivedi (15114261) by two weeks (i.e. up to 10/05/2017).

(c) The SPGC considered the request of Mr. Kunwar Pritiraj Rajput (15104269), Ph.D. student, Dept. of Electrical Engineering, for extension (beyond four semesters) of the deadline for appearing in the comprehensive examination up to June 30, 2017. The SPGC granted extension for appearing in the comprehensive examination up to June 30, 2017 for Mr. Kunwar Pritiraj Rajput (15104269).

The meeting ended with the vote of thanks to the Chair.

(Achla Raina)
Chairperson, SPGC

Copy to: 1. All Members of SPGC
2. Chairman, Senate
3. Senate Coordinator, Prof. Ishan Sharma, Dept. of Mechanical Engineering
4. Dean of Academic Affairs